The Miraculous Journey of Edward Tulane

Adapted by Dwayne Hartford (from the book by Kate DiCamillo)

Suggested Roles:

ACTOR: *Traveler; Edward; Father; Bryce's Father; Neal*
ACTRESS: *Abilene/Shopper; Martin; Bryce; Sarah Ruth; Lucius; Old Doll*

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

TRAVELER: (Pg 7-8) Once, in a house on Egypt Street, there lived a rabbit made almost entirely of china. But how did such a thing come to be? Did the rabbit belong in this fine house? Was this the rabbit's home? Ah. Now that is an interesting question.

INTRODUCTION

ACTRESS: *The Miraculous Journey of Edward Tulane adapted by Dwayne Hartford from the book by Kate DiCamillo.*
ACTOR: *Because if you have no intention to love and be loved, then the whole journey is pointless.*

ABILENE: Oh, grandmother! *(ABILENE takes the rabbit.)* He is the most beautiful thing I have ever seen. Thank you! I love him. *(She considers a name)* Edward . . . Edward Tulane. Just look at him. He's so dignified and refined.

TRAVELER: (Pg 10) Of course, Edward didn't answer. He couldn't, you see. His mouth was painted on, as was the rest of his face. But still he had his thoughts.

EDWARD: (Pg 11-12) I do look good. Now be careful you don't wrinkle my jacket. And fix the tie. I'm sure it's crooked.

FATHER (OFF STAGE): Abilene! Come along now. You'll be late for school, and I'll be late for work.

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ABILENE: Oh, your watch. *(She removes a watch from one of his pockets, winds it and places it in his hand.)* Now remember, when the big hand is on twelve and the little hand is on three, I will come home to you. Have a pleasant day looking out the window.

TRAVELER: And so Edward Tulane spent his days, staring out upon Egypt Street, listening to the ticking of his watch. And at three o'clock Abilene would return.

ABILENE: Hello, Edward. I'm home. And how was your day? *(ABILENE picks up EDWARD)*

EDWARD: What are you doing? Don't move me now. It'll be dark soon, and I'll be able to see my reflection in the window.

ABILENE: Cynthia Worthington is so mean. She wouldn't let me have a turn at recess today.

EDWARD: **(Pg 13)** Blah, blah, blah. Must she go on so? I mean really.

TRAVELER: Yes, Edward had little patience for people. What they said didn't interest him, unless they were talking about him, of course.

ABILENE: **(Pg 19)** *(hugs Edward as she tucks herself and Edward in bed)* Good night, Edward. I don't care how old I get, I will always love you.

EDWARD: Yes, yes, but tum me on my side so that I can see the stars. Oh, dear.

TRAVELER: **(Pg 13)** Life continued this way for years. **(Pg 15)** [Then] one day it was announced that the family would take a voyage on a great ship. **(Pg 19)** Edward, Abilene and her parents set sail for England.

ABILENE: Shall we sit up here on deck, Edward? I believe the sea air will do us good.

EDWARD: Is my hat on straight? I'm sure to be complimented on the hat.

MARTIN: **(Pg 21)** Hey. What does he do? *(Referring to EDWARD)* Does he wind up?

ABILENE: Certainly not. *(MARTIN grabs EDWARD and runs away from ABILENE)*

EDWARD: Stop it! Young man, I demand you release me at once. *(MARTIN throws EDWARD in the air)*

ABILENE: **(Pg 22)** Don't throw him, he's made of china! He'll break! He's mine. Give him to me!

TRAVELER: And Edward flew over the railing and sailed out over the ocean.

ABILENE: Edward! Nol

TRAVELER: As Edward Tulane hit the water, he caught one last glimpse of Abilene, standing on

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the deck, holding his gold pocket watch. **(Pg 23)** Finally he landed on the ocean floor, face down in the muck. Weeks passed. And then months. Edward, for lack of anything better to do, started to think.

EDWARD: Are the stars still shining even though I can't see them anymore? I'll never see the stars again. **(Pg 49)** If I had wings I would fly away. I would fly away high up to the stars.

TRAVELER: **(Pg 24)** On the two hundred and ninety-seventh day [there was] a powerful storm. And up to the surface he came. Before he knew what had happened, Edward was pulled up out of the water.

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BRYCE: **(Pg 51)** Heyl I got you. See? I saved you.

EDWARD: You saved me, but for what?

BRYCE: My little sister had a baby doll that was made out of china just like you. She loved that doll, but ***he*** come home drunk, stepped on the doll's head and smashed it into a hundred million pieces. I couldn't make them go back together. I tried and tried. Sarah Ruth ain't had nothing to play with since.

EDWARD: *(disdainfully)* So you want me to be the replacement for a doll.

BRYCE: He says she don't need nothing because she's sick and ain't gonna live. But he don't know.

TRAVELER: **(Pg 52-53)** They arrived at a house. It was small and crooked – not much more than a shack.

BRYCE: Sarah? *(Sarah Ruth coughs violently)* Want to see what I brung you? Close your eyes. *(Sarah Ruth stops coughing and closes her eyes – Bryce holds up Edward)* All right, you can open them. *(Bryce moves Edward as if he is dancing – Sarah Ruth laughs)* I got him special for you.

EDWARD: Special *(Sarah Ruth holds Edward like a baby)* No one has ever held me like this.

BRYCE: From the minute I first seen him, I knew you two belonged together. What's his name?

SARAH RUTH: Jangles *(She rocks Edward back and forth)*

TRAVELER: Later that night after the brother and sister had fallen asleep, a large figure

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appeared over Sarah Ruth's bed. *(The children awake)*

BRYCE: **(Pg 54-55)** *(fearful, but also defiant)* It's a doll. He belongs to her.

BRYCE'S FATHER: Don't you sass me. *(He raises a hand and strikes; Bryce reacts to the slap)*

BRYCE: *(long pause as father exits)* I'm all right. He hardly touched me. But he'll feel bad about it and won't come around for a while. And that's just fine with us, ain't it, Sarah Ruth?

EDWARD: *(to SARAH RUTH)* I wish I could protect you from that man. I wish I could.

TRAVELER: Days passed. Every morning Bryce went out to find food for his sister. Edward spent all his time with Sarah Ruth. Some days they played with an old cigar box filled with buttons. *(SARAH RUTH starts to cough. She grabs EDWARD and holds him tightly)*

EDWARD: I wish I could protect you -- from everything. But I can only ... You just hold on tight.

BRYCE: Hey there, honey. Now, I'II hold Jangles; him and me got a surprise for you. *(BRYCE takes EDWARD and hides the rabbit from SARAH RUTH while he attaches the strings.)* I got this idea the first night I brung him to you. Today, I was working for the junk man. And he said I could have some of this here twine. **(Pg 56-57)** When you were really little, Mama used to dance with you. She used to hold you and dance you around the room.

SARAH RUTH: Mama. Died.

BRYCE: Well now we have another dancer in the house. Dance, Jangles. *(BRYCE has rigged EDWARD with strings like a marionette.)*

EDWARD: What's happening to me?

SARAH RUTH: *(Sarah Ruth laughs)* Dancing!

EDWARD: Do you like it, Sarah Ruth? *(SARAH RUTH applauds and laughs.)* Bryce! Make my legs kick again! She loves that! *(EDWARD joins the laughing. SARAH RUTH's laughing turns to coughing.)*

BRYCE: You want some fresh air? Let's go take a peek at the stars for a minute.

EDWARD: If l had wings, I would fly high up to the stars, where the air is clear and sweet. I would hold Sarah Ruth in my arms, and high above the world, she could breathe and laugh and talk, and she wouldn't ever have to cough again.

TRAVELER: Days and weeks passed. Sarah Ruth grew weaker. *(BRYCE plays the harmonica as*

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EDWARD dances.)

EDWARD: Why isn't she laughing? Sarah Ruth? I'm doing the kicks you like. Sarah Ruth? *(BRYCE stops playing and goes to SARAH RUTH's side.)* Don't stop! Keep playing, Bryce! Keep playing!

TRAVELER: But Bryce stopped playing.

EDWARD: **(Pg 58-59)** Breathe. Please, please, breathe.

TRAVELER: Then, on a bright morning in September, six months after Edward first came to the shack, Sarah Ruth stopped breathing.

BRYCE: No reason to stay here no more. Come on, Jangles.

TRAVELER: Under a hot, late-summer sun, the boy silently carried the rabbit all the way into the city.

BRYCE: I bet nobody's ever seen a dancing rabbit before. Well, they're going to see one now. *(BRYCE plays the harmonica and manipulates EDWARD to dance.)*

TRAVELER: Bryce set out Sarah Ruth's button box and people dropped pennies and nickels into it. Edward Tulane danced on a dirty street comer. On and on, Bryce played. On and on, Edward danced.

EDWARD: Are you crying, Bryce? Tears. Do they help?

BRYCE: **(Pg 60)** *(wiping his tears and picks up the button box)* Looks like we got us enough money to get something to eat. Come on, Jangles.

TRAVELER: The diner was called Neal's. Bryce sat at the counter. He set Edward on the stool next to him.

BRYCE: Give me some pancakes, and some eggs, and steak, too.

TRAVELER: He ate it all – [but when the check came. . .]

BRYCE: I ain't got enough.

NEAL: **(Pg 61-62)** *(angry and threatening)* You came in here hungry, right? You ordered some food - a lot of food - and I cooked it, right? You ate it. Now, I want my money.

BRYCE: You ever seen a rabbit dance? *(BRYCE starts manipulating EDWARD to dance)* He could dance to pay for what I ate.

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EDWARD: I can! Watch! I'll pay for him! I will!

NEAL: *(NEAL grabs EDWARD)* This is what I think of dancing rabbits.

TRAVELER: Edward felt himself swinging through the air. He was moving so quickly he couldn't see Bryce. He couldn't see Neal. He couldn't see the countertop. *(NEAL slams EDWARD's head into the countertop.)* And the world -- Edward's world -- went black.

EDWARD: *(in a dream vision)* Wait - I know this house. I'm on Egypt Street. How did I get here? Abilene?

ABILENE: **(Pg 63)** Edward! I've never forgotten you. I say your name every day.

EDWARD: The stars. *(EDWARD looks up at the stars.)* Sarah Ruth?

BRYCE: Hey, Jangles.

EDWARD: Bryce! *(pointing to the stars)* Sarah Ruth is in the stars! **(Pg 64)** I want to be with her. If only I had wings. *(Wings are revealed on EDWARD 's back)* What is happening to me? Wings! Sarah Ruth! I'm coming! *(he begins to cry)* **(Pg 65)** My heard is broken.

******* A Doll Shop*******

LUCIUS: Exceedingly well made. You don't see craftsmanship like this every day. How did you end up so dirty and abused? I fixed your broken head. Now I'll fix the rest of you. I'm Lucius Clarke. I'm a doll mender, and a rather good one at that. Your head was in twenty-one pieces.

EDWARD: Where am I? Twenty-one pieces.

LUCIUS: **(Pg 66)** A crying little boy brought you here. He couldn't afford my services so he gave you to me if I promised to repair you.

EDWARD: Bryce . . . You should have left my head in twenty-one pieces. I will never be truly whole again.

LUCIUS: Someday. Eventually. All in good time. In the doll business, we have a saying: there is real time, and there is doll time.

TRAVELER: Edward Tulane entered doll time - a time of waiting. Slowly and carefully, Lucius Clarke did everything he said he would. Except for the very faint lines on his face, Edward Tulane looked the same as he did many years ago. Edward was placed on a high

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shelf for display.

EDWARD: **(Pg 67)** I am done with hope. I am done with love. I am done.

LUCIUS: *(He sets an old restored doll on the shelf next to EDWARD)* Here you go, my lovely. Sit here, next to this gentleman. You two have much in common. You have both been saved.

OLD DOLL: How do you do? Have you been here long?

EDWARD: Yes, months and months. But I don't care. One place is the same as the other.

OLD DOLL: But that's not true! I've lived for a hundred years and I've been in countless places. Some were wonderful and some were dreadful. But they are never the same. That's part of the adventure, you know? **(Pg 68)** My face has its share of cracks as well. I too have seen life. We have learned, yes?

EDWARD: Yes. Hard lessons.

OLD DOLL: Wonderful lessons. And we keep learning, don't we? Every time a new person comes into our lives, we start off on a new adventure. I wonder who will come for me this time. Someone will come. They always do.

EDWARD: I don't care if anyone comes for me.

OLD DOLL: Don't say that! You must keep your heart open, ready to love and to be loved.

EDWARD: I'm done with being loved. I'm done with loving. It's too painful.

OLD DOLL: **(Pg 69)** You disappoint me. If you have no intention to love and be loved, then the whole journey is pointless. Someone will come for you. But first, you must open your heart.

EDWARD: Someone will come. Someone will come.

TRAVELER: And every time he thought those words, he allowed himself to hope a little more. Weeks turned into months. Months turned into years.

EDWARD: Someone will come.

TRAVELER: Then one rainy spring morning, someone came.

SHOPPER: **(Pg 70-71)** I'm looking for something for my daughter. Something ... unique.

LUCIUS: *(He lifts EDWARD off the shelf)* Madam, if I may. This one's not a doll. Perhaps he is

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what you are looking for. *(The SHOPPER takes EDWARD and stares into his eyes)*

EDWARD: I know you.

TRAVELER: A memory came to Edward Tulane. The memory of a little girl, many years ago. Abilene . . . a little girl who had grown up into a woman.

SHOPPER: Edward? *(She hugs Edward as he cries - Beat)*

TRAVELER: Once, there was a china rabbit who was loved by a little girl. *(beat)* Once there was a rabbit who loved a little girl and watched her die. The rabbit danced on the streets to the music of a sad little boy. The rabbit's head was broken and put together again by a doll mender. And the rabbit swore that he would not make the mistake of loving again. *(beat)* Once, oh marvelous once, there was a rabbit who found his way home.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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